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Hiring Committee
Andersen Institute for Finance & Economics
1850 K St. NW #675
Washington, DC 20006
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Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Research Economist position at the Andersen Institute for Finance & Economics. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary areas of specialization are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda is focused on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate distributions of wealth similar to those that we can measure empirically. A contributing factor to wealth accumulation over the life cycle is the rate of return earned on assets, so understanding the available data on wealth holding and methods to compute measures of returns is of much importance to my work. These topics are directly relevant to corporate and policy decision-making under uncertainty.

In my job market paper, I match wealth moments from the SCF by simulating a model in which households differ in the return earned on their assets. This modeling choice is motivated by the recent literature which documents substantial heterogeneity in portfolio returns across individuals, even within narrowly defined asset classes. In another research project, I analyze the relationship between trust and returns measured in the HRS. It is known that the empirical relationship between trust and measures of economic performance like income is hump shaped – an intermediate amount of trust is associated with the maximal level of income. Not only am I able to replicate the hump-shaped relationship found in the literature in the HRS data, but I find that a similar relationship also holds for the constructed measure of returns. I also characterize the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth (a finding that motivated the modeling choices in my job market paper) for multiple waves of the HRS data.

The Andersen Institute's mission to deliver rigorous, data-driven perspectives to business leaders and policymakers, and its stated research priorities (how markets price risks and opportunities, corporate decision-making, and the economic implications of AI, geopolitics, and secular forces), align closely with the questions I study. I would welcome the opportunity to translate my technical work into the kinds of white papers, working papers, and executive briefs the Institute produces to inform C-suite and policy audiences.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to firm and policy responses to changing macro and geopolitical conditions,

and (iii) collaborate across teams to present results in concise, actionable formats for non-technical audiences. I am excited by the Institute's structure and expert advisory board, which creates a direct bridge between rigorous academic analysis and high-impact practitioner engagement — an environment where I expect my work to have tangible influence.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how my research program could support the Andersen Institute's agenda. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards